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STRENGTHENING SAMSUNG'S MOBILE ECOSYSTEM

By : Vin Kim
Raj Nandani
Liyan Fang
Ziyue Xu

AGENDA

- Samsung ecosystem map
- Ecosystem benchmark
- SWOT analysis
- Ecosystem performance awareness
- Channel-specific improvement recommendations
- Strategic roadmap

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Primary Research: Survey Findings

n = 149 Sheffield students

78.5%

Use iphone

Vs Samsung 12.1%

75.2%

Own **NO** Samsung

112of 149 respondents

45.6%

NEVER exposed to Samsung features

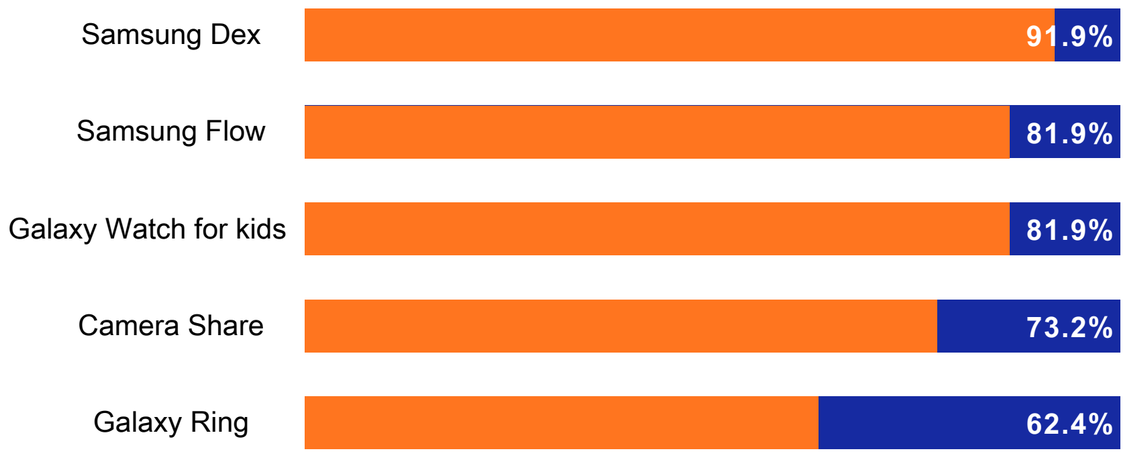
Vs Apple only 8.7%

10.1%

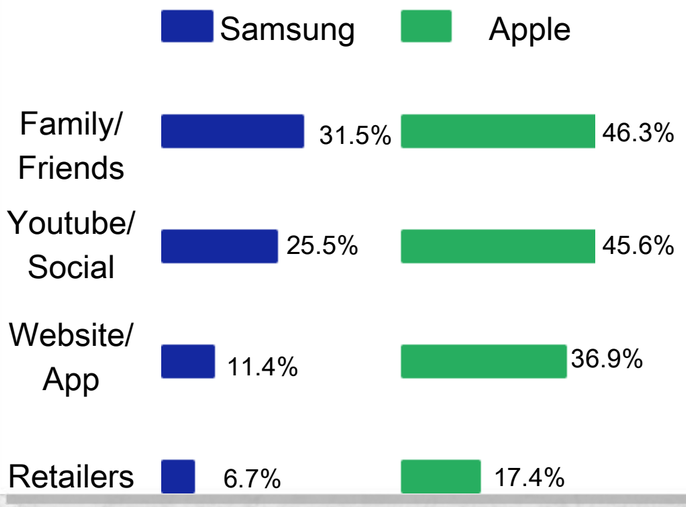
TOP Samsung feature usage

Link to Window feature

Feature Awareness Gap (% 'Never Heard of It')



How Awareness was formed



Beyond the Data

Distributed across the University of Sheffield Internship Programme a cohort of **700** students

Every question answered was a Galaxy feature discovered.

Survey conducted April 2025 · University of Sheffield Internship Cohort · 149 responses | All data collected first-hand by the team

Data-Drive Reality: Survey & Market Findings

78.5%

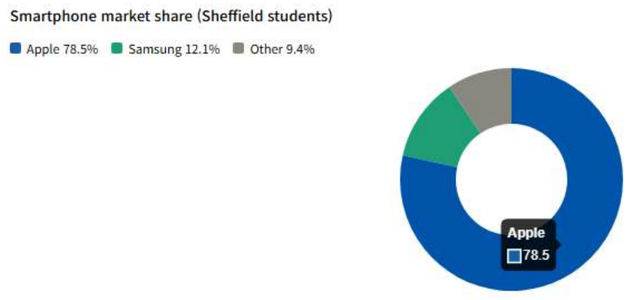
Respondents use iPhone

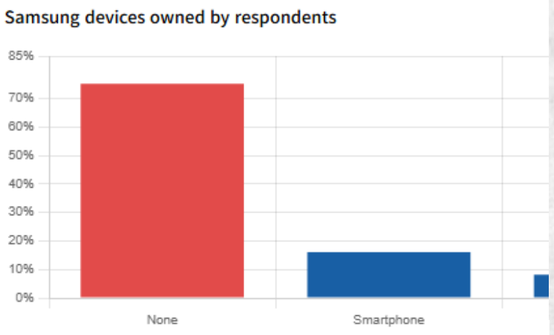
Future conversion opportunity

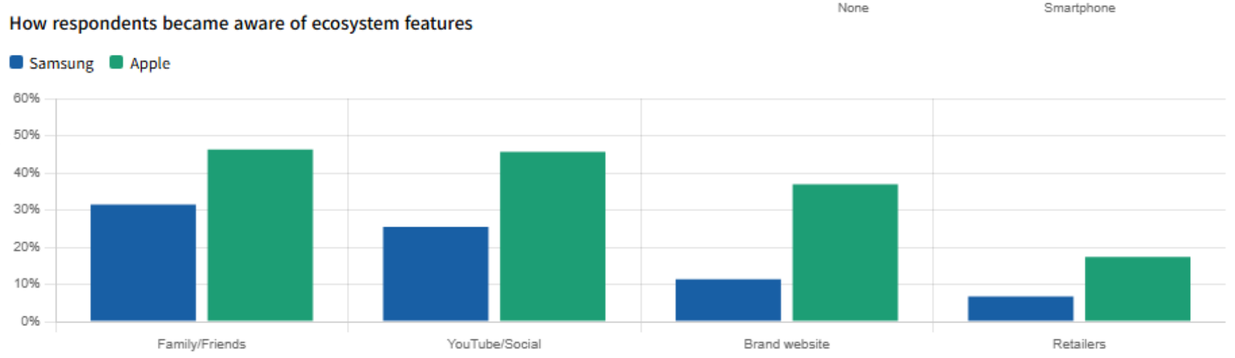
45.6%

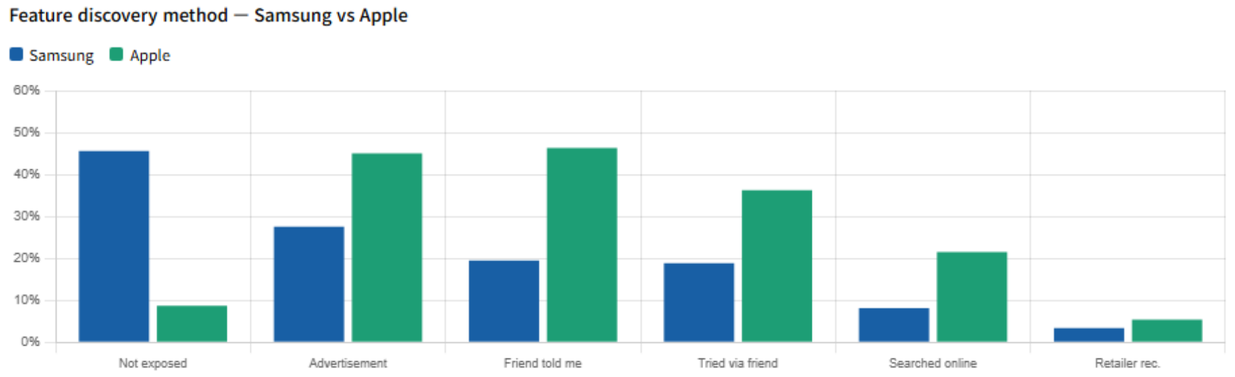
Never exposed to Samsung features

Awareness must precede adoption









6.7%

Retailer channel awareness

vs Apple 17.4% - channels failing

31.5%

Samsung word-of-mouth

vs Apple 46.3% - weaker community

Samsung Mobile Ecosystem Map

Mobile Devices (Key Access)

Smartphones
Galaxy S / Z / A

Tablets
Galaxy Tab S Series

Wearables
Galaxy Watch / Galaxy Ring

Galaxy Buds
True Wireless Earbuds

Services (Connecting Layer)

SmartThings | Samsung Wallet | Samsung Health

Integrations (Key to User Experience)

Multi Control | Quick Share | Link to Windows | SmartThings Control

Enables connectivity across devices

Enhances seamless multi-device interaction

One UI — Unified User Experience

android OS — Powered by Google

The Platform (Foundational Layer)

Underpins the ecosystem architecture

Distribution Channels (Drive Monetisation

Enables ecosystem monetisation

Samsung.com	EE / O2	Argos / Currys	Amazon
D2C Online Store & Samsung Direct	Carrier Partners	Retail Channels	Amazon

UK Market Position

~ 50%

Apple UK market share

~ 30%

Samsung UK ownership

50%

Samsung brand loyalty

59%

16–24s prefer iOS

Key Market Insights

- Samsung gained **+4pp in ownership share (2023–2025)**, the only major brand to show meaningful growth (Mintel, 2025).
- Apple **lost –6pp over the same period** yet remains the leader, demonstrating the strength of its ecosystem lock-in.
- UK mobile phone sales rebounded in 2024, driven by easing cost-of-living pressures and major new launches.
- Samsung's core challenge: lies in the relatively **low consumer awareness** and **understanding of its integrated ecosystem.**

Competitive Benchmark: Samsung vs Apple vs Google

Dimension	Samsung	Apple	Google
ECOSYSTEM STRENGTH			
Ecosystem Type	Hybrid / Hardware-led	Closed / Vertically integrated	Data / Service-based
Cross-device Continuity	Galaxy Flow, Link to Windows, DeX	AirDrop, Handoff, iCloud, Universal Clipboard	Google Cast, Chrome sync, Cross-device clipboard
App Ecosystem Quality	Full Android/Play Store access	App Store (premium app-first)	Play Store + best Google apps
AI Integration	Galaxy AI, Gemini (via Samsung-Google deal Jan 2025)	Apple Intelligence, Siri	Gemini native, Google Assistant
Security & Privacy	Knox (enterprise-grade), rated #1 Secure (Mintel)	Secure Enclave, App Tracking Transparency	Data-monetisation model, privacy perception weaker
Ecosystem Openness	Open Android – Galaxy Watch pairs with any Android phone	Closed – Apple Watch requires iPhone to set up	Semi-open – runs on Android, iOS, Windows
Service / Subscription Revenue	Samsung TV+, Knox, Wallet; minimal services revenue	Apple One, iCloud, Apple TV+, Music, Arcade; $109B service revenue	Google One, YouTube Premium, Workspace; strong but ad-dependent

Colour Coding:

Green = Leading
Yellow= Competitive
Orange = Lagging

ECOSYSTEM LOCK-IN STRENGTH

Apple

92% retention
(Very Strong)

Samsung

77% retention
(Medium

Apple's 3 Core Lock-in Engines

•iMessage social lock-in — dominates UK youth group chats ('Green Bubble' pressure)
•Data migration friction — iCloud photos, Health data and app history are hard to transfer
•Service bundle economics — post Apple One subscription, the cost of leaving exceeds the benefit of switching

Samsung's Double-Edged Openness

Galaxy Watch pairs with any Android phone — unlike Apple Watch which requires an iPhone. This openness lowers the barrier to entry but simultaneously weakens ecosystem lock-in. It is both Samsung's strength and its strategic vulnerability.

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

- Strong & diverse product ecosystem (smartphones, tablets,wearables, Buds, SmartThings)
- High openness & compatibility — broader Android integrationlowers entry barriers
- Attainable premium brand positioning — desirable yet more accessible than Apple

Weaknesses

- Low ecosystem usage & weak lock-in → key features (DeX, QuickShare) remain unknown
- Weak D2C performance → heavily reliant on third-party retailers
- Low penetration among younger consumers (16–24 age group dominated by Apple)

Opportunities

- Untapped student market — large proportion don't own Samsung; bundle entry opportunity
- Convert Galaxy AI awareness into real ecosystem usage through education & experience
- Stronger channel partnerships (Amazon UK, Currys, Argos) via co-branded promotions

Threats

- Apple's strong ecosystem lock-in — leads in retention, cross-device usage, and features
- Samsung risks losing visibility during key retail seasons **vs** consistently strong Apple campaigns

UK Advertising Spend & Strategic Gap

- Samsung UK: £39.3M total — digital-centred (£10.8M digital)

→ Spend is high but awareness uplift is low

- Apple UK: £26.6M total — TV-centred (£18.1M TV).

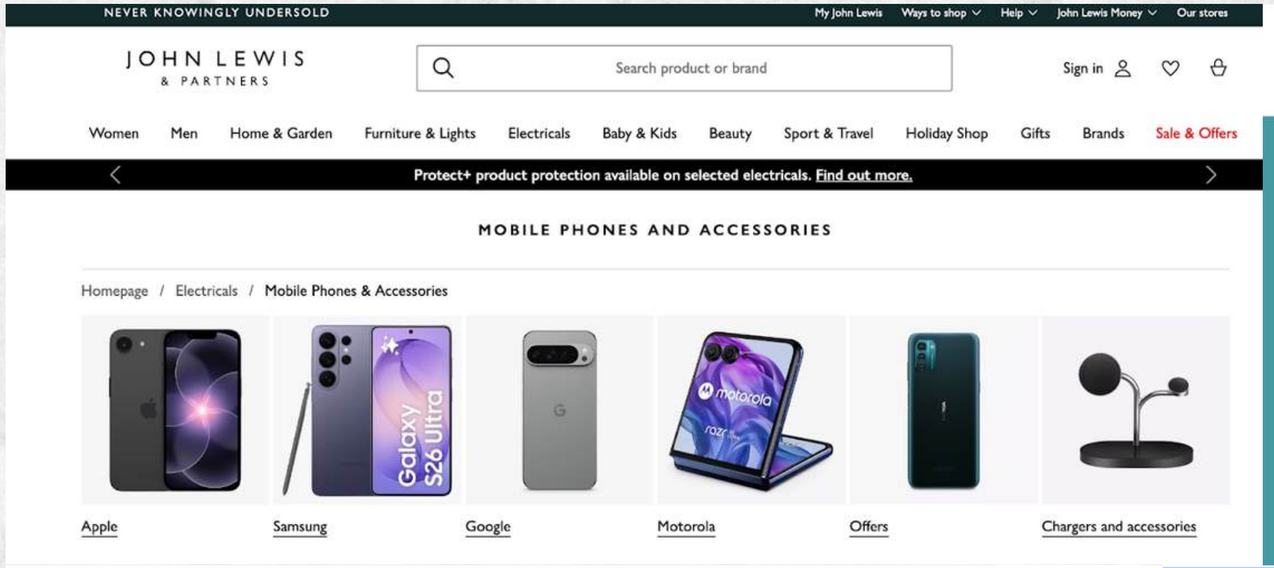
→ Less spend, stronger brand salience via mass media

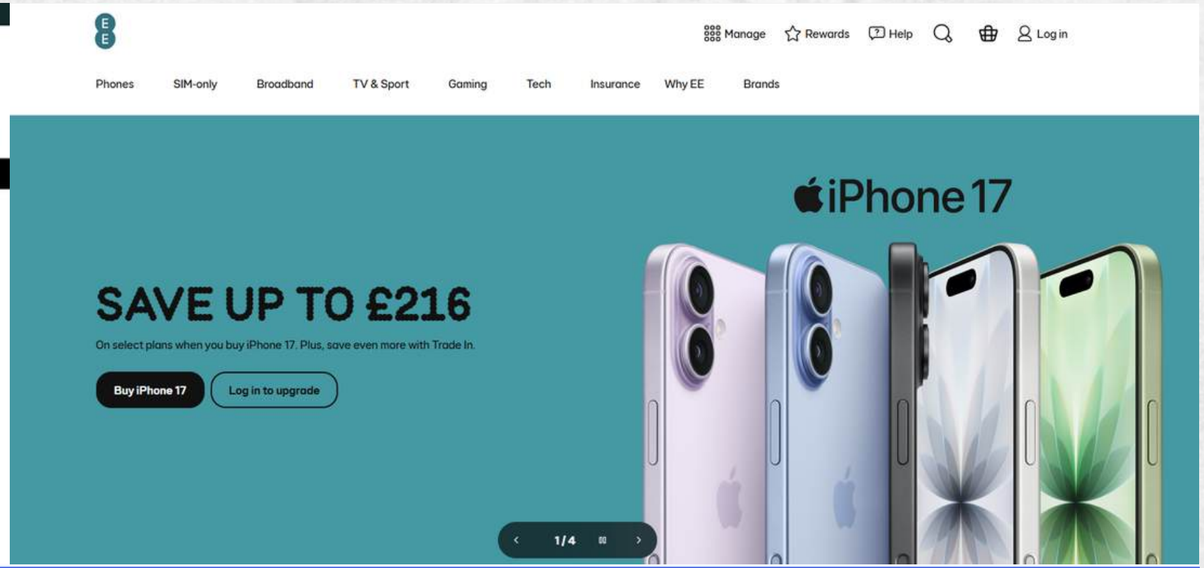
- Samsung's spending is concentrated around Galaxy Unpacked, creating a Christmas season visibility gap

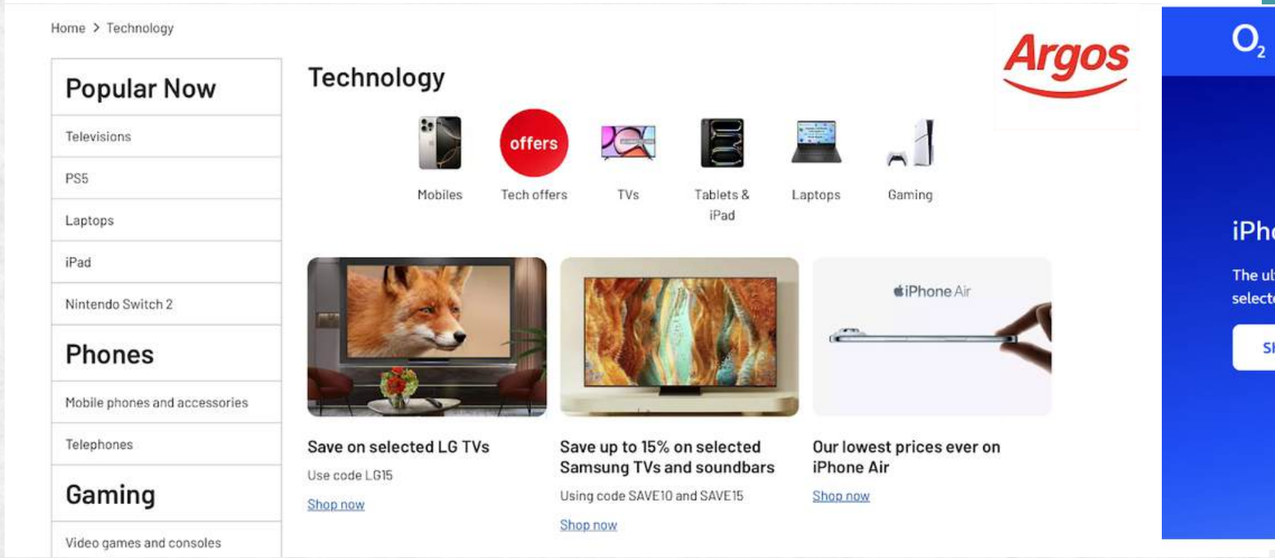
- Strategic fix: redirect spend towards where students actually are — deliver experience, not just ads

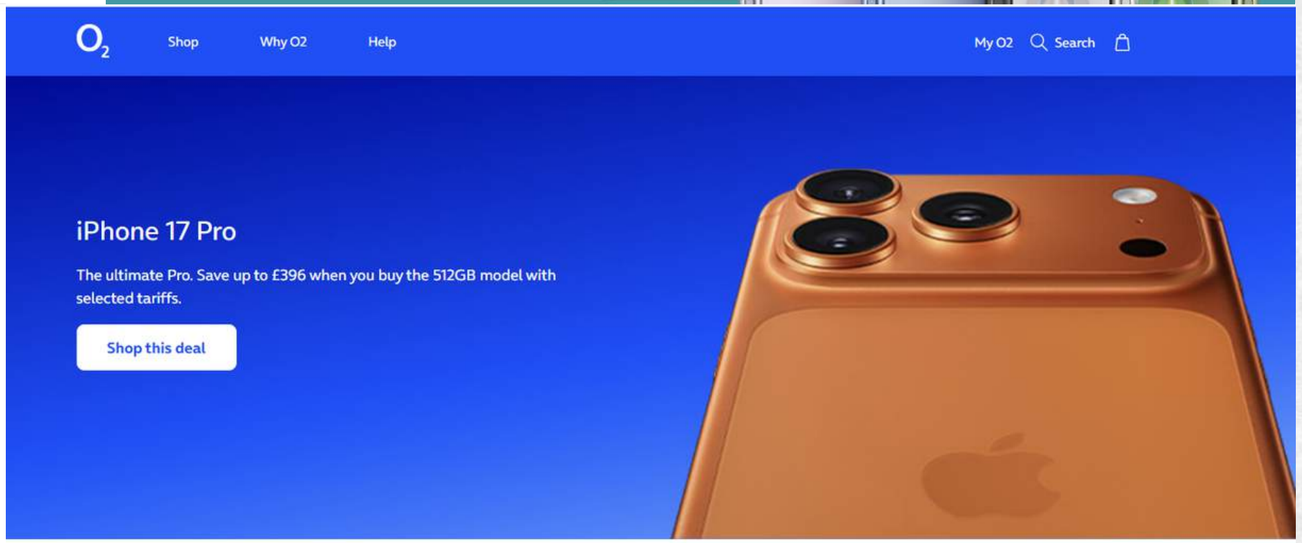
(Source: Mintel, 2025)

Channel Web page Recommendations









CURRENT CHANNEL GAP

1. Still product-focused, not ecosystem-focused.
2. No Samsung brand loyalty built, mainly driven by price.
3. Samsung ecosystem are rarely present.

Channel-Specific Recommendations

Mass Retail – High Volume

- **Cross-industry ecosystem voucher partnerships** (Tesco, M&S, Zara)
- → (e.g.Tesco: Redeem Clubcard vouchers for cinema tickets / subscriptions with **cineworld** and **Disney+**)
- Bundle upgrade prompts at checkout

Increase basket size & accessory attach rate

Digital – Subscription & Ecosystem

- **3-month free trials** (Prime Video/Music) with Samsung purchase
- Exclusive 'Prime Day ecosystem deals' bundles
- Smart recommendation — 'Frequently bought together'

Drive online conversion & recurring engagement

Tech Retail – High-Value Bundles

- **Student Bundles**: Galaxy A57 + Galaxy Book 15'6" + Galaxy Buds FE
- **Office Worker Bundles**: Samsung Galaxy S26+ + Galaxy Book6 Pro 16" + Galaxy Watch 8
- **Family Bundles:** Galaxy Watch8 LTE + Galaxy Tab A9+11" + Galaxy Buds FE
- **Fitness Bundles:** Galaxy Ring + Galaxy Watch 40mm BT + Galaxy Buds FE

Increase average order value & ecosystem penetration

Telecom – Contract Lock-in

- **Post-purchase add-on incentives** (e.g. free accessories- Tempered glass, Clear gel case)
- Android trade-in and upgrade incentives within the Samsung ecosystem

Drive long-term lock-in & recurring revenue

3-Year Strategic Roadmap

Short-term (0–12 Months)

Awareness & Experience

1. **Channel Website Optimisation (EE, Argos, O2)**
   - Redesign key retail partner webpages to highlight the Samsung ecosystem
   - Use bundle visuals (phone + Buds + Watch + Tablet) to improve ecosystem awareness

2. **Student Ecosystem Campaign**
   - Launch a campus activation campaign targeting university students
   - Provide opportunities to experience the Samsung ecosystem firsthand (e.g. pop-ups, trial programmes)

3. **In-Store Experience & Ecosystem Specialists**
   - Introduce Galaxy Experience Zones in high-traffic retail stores
   - Create small demo setups
   - Assign at least one Galaxy Ecosystem Specialist per store

Mid-term (1-2 Years)

Conversion & Loyalty

1. **Bundle Incentives: Gift Voucher + Student Discount**
   - Introduce stackable incentives (gift vouchers + student discounts) to increase purchase attractiveness
   - Offer ecosystem bundles (e.g., Galaxy phone + Buds) at a reduced combined price
   - Align promotions with key sales period (e.g., Back-to-School, Black Friday)

2. **Exclusive Ecosystem Events (Loyalty & Lock-in)**
   - Host invite-only events for Samsung users (e.g. early access product launches, ecosystem demo sessions)
   - Provide: Trade-in bonuses. Exclusive discounts. Early access to new products + ecosystem
   - Collaborate with influencers and celebrities to enhance experience

Long-term (3 Years)

Lock-in & Growth

1. **Expand Samsung Account & Payment Ecosystem**
   - Increase adoption of Samsung Account and Samsung Wallet by integrating with UK checkout systems
   - Partner with major e-commerce platforms to add Samsung Pay as a payment option (similar to Apple Pay / Google Pay)
   - Enable one-click login and payment using Samsung Account across apps and websites

2. **Character & Cultural Collaborations**
   - Partner with popular IPs (e.g. Harry Potter) to create co-branded ecosystem experiences
   - Set up Galaxy Experience Zones in themed locations (e.g. Studios, flagship stores)
   - Offer product personalisation

CHANNEL STRATEGY

Partner In-store Experience Zone

Goal: Drive hands-on ecosystem discovery at point of purchase

1. **Galaxy Experience Zones** in partner stores
   → Live cross-device demos in high traffic stores

2. **Galaxy Ecosystem Specialist**
   → Dedicated Samsung staff per partner store to guide, demo and convert

Student Ecosystem Campaign

Goal: Awareness → First-time usage → Long-term ecosystem loyalty

1. **Campus pop-ups & trial programmes**
   → hands-on experience of cross-device connectivity at university

2. **Live ecosystem demos**
   → file sharing, device sync & productivity shown in real academic contexts

3. **First device → full ecosystem** — once students adopt one product, loyalty drives repeat purchases across the range

CHANNEL STRATEGY

Charater & Cultural Collabotations

Goal: Drive brand engagement & younger audience appeal

1. Partner with popular IPs (e.g. Harry Potter) for co-branded Galaxy Experience Zones
2. Galaxy Experience Zones in themed & flagship locations — live demos in-context
3. Product personalisation — engraving, character designs, limited-edition Galaxy Ring collabs

Experience Galaxy AI's Photo Assist to generate a photo with your favourite character

Galaxy AI

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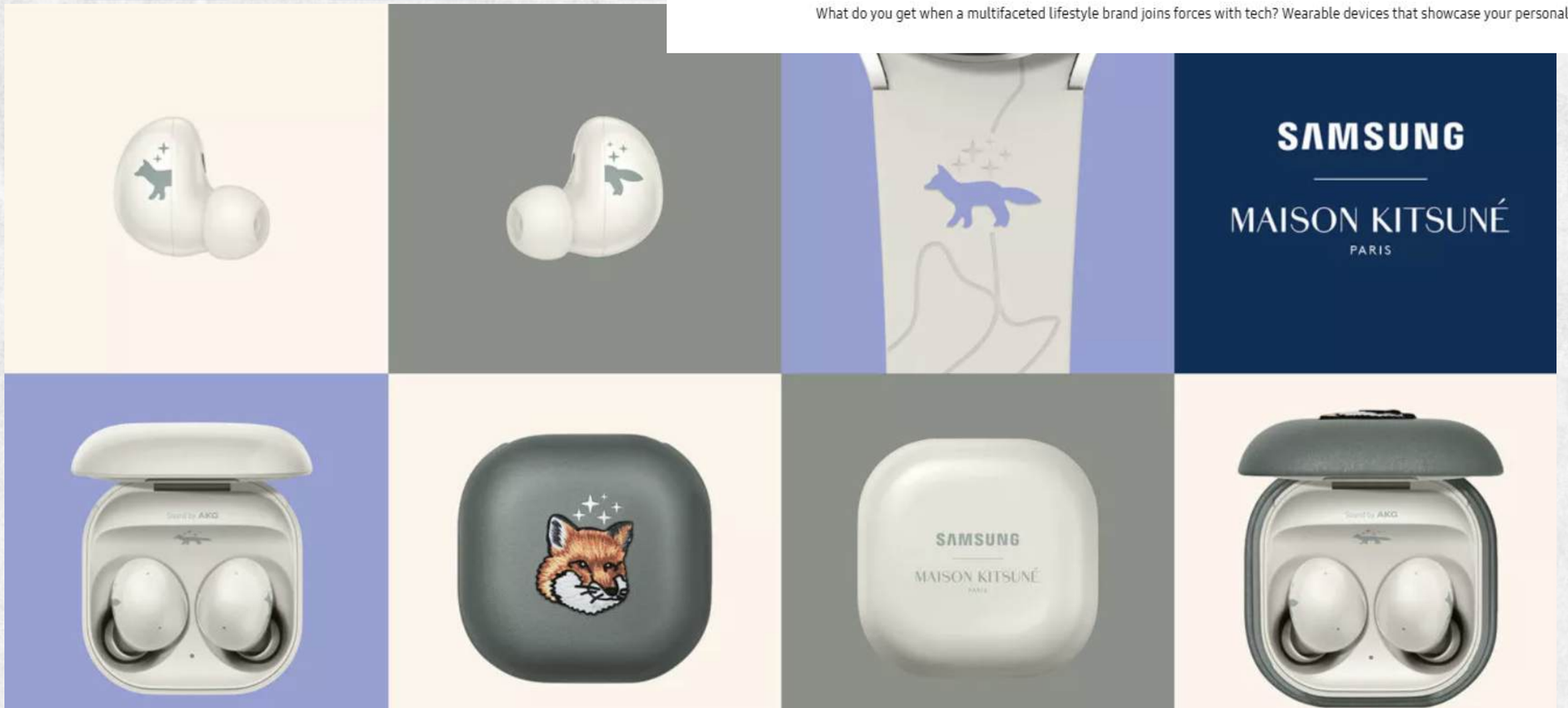
BRAND

When Samsung Galaxy meets the Maison Kitsuné Fox

What do you get when a multifaceted lifestyle brand joins forces with tech? Wearable devices that showcase your personal style.



Conclusion

Ecosystem Strength ≠ Product Strength

Samsung’s hardware is competitive, but its ecosystem lacks the integration and lock-in strength of Apple.

Awareness Without Adoption is Wasted

Galaxy AI awareness jumped from 30% to 80% — but 45.6% of usershave never been exposed to core Samsung features.
→ Converting awareness into behaviour is the next imperative.

Channels Are Underperforming

Retail channels play a limited role in communicating ecosystem value compared to Apple, highlighting missed opportunities in in-store experience and staff-led engagement.

Students Are the Strategic Battleground

Younger consumers show a strong preference for iOS, making students a critical segment for early ecosystem adoption and long-term loyalty.

THANKYOU

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